

Step 1: Database Setup & Health Check

- Imported `kobe_basketball_reference_stats.csv` into DBeaver.
- Ran initial validation queries (`SELECT *`) to confirm data integrity.

Step 2: SQL Analysis & Querying

- Built and verified the **Offence** queries (Shot Selection, Scoring & Efficiency, Volume Breakdown).
- Built and verified the **Defence** queries (Defensive Lockdown, Defensive Trade-Off).
- Built and verified the **Two-Way** query (Two-Way Impact combining `PTS`, `AST`, `STL`, `BLK`).

Step 3: Tableau Connection & Dashboard Design *(Up Next)*

- Connect your SQL outputs directly to Tableau.
- Build the **Offence Dashboard** (visualizing shot evolution and efficiency).
- Build the **Defence Dashboard** (visualizing disruption trends and foul behaviour).
- Build the **Two-Way Dashboard** (pinpointing his peak dual-threat seasons).

Offence Dashboard: Shot selection, efficiency, and volume.

Defence Dashboard: Lockdown steals/blocks and the personal foul trade-off.

Two-Way Dashboard: The full statistical impact combining scoring, playmaking, and defence

Build the Offence Dashboard

- **Data Sources:**
 - **Shot Selection: Season, 3PA, 2PA**
The Two-Point Dominance: For the vast majority of his career, Kobe made significantly more 2-point field goals than 3-pointers, with his 2-point production peaking early-to-mid career around 9 made shots per game.
 - **The 2005-06 Scoring Explosion:** The chart highlights a massive convergence in the **2005-06 season** (where the tooltip shows 2P at 8.8), which corresponds to his famous 35.4 points-per-game scoring season

where he shot a heavy volume of both midrange/inside shots and deep perimeter shots.

- **Evolution of the Three-Pointer:** His 3-point production (gold line) shows an upward trend in overall volume and variance as his career progressed, spiking notably in his later years (such as 2014-15) when he relied more heavily on perimeter shooting as his athleticism changed.
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- **Scoring & Efficiency:** **Season, PTS, FG%, eFG**

The Ascent (1996–1999): Starting as an explosive teenager off the bench, his scoring volume (yellow line) climbs rapidly from under 8 PPG to nearly 20 PPG by his third season.

- **The Peak Scoring Era (2005–2007):** His offensive load skyrockets right here, highlighted by his career-high scoring peak in the 2005–06 season (crossing 35 PPG) during an era where he carried a massive offensive burden for the Lakers.
- **The Veteran Efficiency Phase (2008–2013):** Even as his raw scoring dips slightly into the mid-to-high 20s, his efficiency lines up smoothly, maintaining a consistent performance baseline alongside Pau Gasol and company.
- **The Twilight & Injuries (2013–2016):** You can vividly see the sharp drop-off starting around the 2013–14 season due to his Achilles injury and subsequent seasons, wrapping up with his 60-point finale in 2015–16.

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Volume Breakdown: **Season, 2PA, 3PA, FGA**

- **The Two-Pointer Dominance:** The top purple line (2PA) tracks almost identical to total attempts (FGA), proving that his game was built from the inside and mid-range for the vast majority of his 20 seasons.
- **The Three-Point Evolution:** The bottom gray line (3PA) shows how his perimeter volume stayed relatively steady and disciplined through his prime years, only ticking up during specific seasons as the league's style changed around him.
- **The Peak Burden (2005–2006):** You can see both FGA and 2PA spiking to their absolute maximums right during his 35+ PPG scoring tear, reflecting just how much he had to carry the offensive load single-handedly

Build the Defence Dashboard

- **Data Sources:**
 - ***Defensive Lockdown:* Season, STL, BLK**
 - **The Steals Trend (Gold Area):** Kobe's steal numbers peaked significantly during his athletic prime in the early-to-mid 2000s, reaching an individual career-high average of **2.2 steals per game in the 2002–03 season**. As his career progressed into the later years, his steal rate gradually tapered off down to around 1.0 to 1.3 per game.
 - **The Blocks Trend (Purple Line):** His shot-blocking numbers followed a similar arc, peaking twice earlier in his career—first around the 1998–99 season and again during the 2002–03 season (both hitting around **0.8 to 1.0 blocks per game**). In his later seasons, his block rate settled down closer to 0.2 per game.

Together, the chart highlights how his defensive disruption and active hands were at their absolute peak during his early-to-prime championship years, then stabilized as he aged.

***Defensive Trade-Off:* Season, STL, PF**

Based on this chart, Kobe Bryant's career defensive trajectory shows a clear arc from high-energy youth into a seasoned veteran role:

- **The Athletic Peak (Early 2000s):** Both his steals (gold line) and personal fouls (purple line) hit their highest numbers during his athletic prime and championship years. This reflects an aggressive, high-motor style of defence where he actively jumped passing lanes and pressured opponents heavily, naturally leading to both more steals and more whistle-blown fouls.
- **The Veteran Decline (Later Career):** As he moved into the later stages of his career, both metrics trend downward. This shows a strategic shift in his playing style—conserving his energy on defence to carry a massive offensive workload, playing smarter positional defence to avoid fouls, and recording fewer steals as his pure foot speed declined.
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4. Build the Two-Way Dashboard

- **Data Source:** **Season, STL, BLK, PTS, AST**
- The Offensive Core (Top Panel): Points (purple) dominate the visual weight, showing how he anchored the offence from his early years right through his massive 2005–06 scoring peak, while assists (gold) maintained a steady, reliable baseline around 5 per game.

The Defensive Peak (Bottom Panel): Steals and blocks spike during his early-to-mid 2000s championship and athletic prime years, proving he was an elite two-way lockdown presence before tapering off into a more conservative veteran defensive role later on.